

SAKET KUMAR

Senior Risk Manager — Credit Risk Modeling & Model Governance | Kotak Mahindra Bank

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Risk Manager on the Model Governance team at Kotak Mahindra Bank with ~2 years of experience in credit risk modeling, model validation, and ML-driven decisioning across a consumer lending book. Delivered **₹550 Cr+ incremental business** via an MFI challenger scorecard (10% Gini lift) and built a bank-wide consumer exposure-cap framework productionized on Airflow. IISc Business Analytics (Distinction); **GATE 2022 AIR-6**; Top Gun & Best Performer awards at Kotak.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Risk Manager, Model Governance | Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited, Bengaluru Jul 2024 – Present

- **Delivered ₹550 Cr+ incremental business** by building a **challenger Microfinance acquisition model** with **10% Gini lift** over the developer model at **half the bad rate** of ongoing models; secured external validation approval, deployed on **Azure DevOps** for automated scoring of the Kotak MFI portfolio, and run monthly decile-level performance monitoring shared with the risk team
- **Enterprise-wide Customer-Level Exposure Management Framework**
 - Designed a customer-level exposure management framework controlling aggregate credit exposure, parallel funding, and over-leveraging across Secured, Unsecured Term, and Revolving products — **3-stage eligibility logic** (total, aggregate unsecured, product-specific exposure) built on a **Risk-Affordability Grid (5 risk tiers × 5 income bands)** preserving monotonic risk-based rank ordering
 - Engineered risk tiers via **decision-tree modelling** on **~15,000 bureau and banking variables** across a **6.1 crore-customer** development base; derived product-specific exposure multipliers — with differentiated CIBIL Thick/Thin treatment — using normalized bad-rate gradients, polynomial/exponential smoothing, and cohort-level exposure percentiles (P75)
 - Validated multipliers through **EMI-to-income affordability analysis** under product-specific rate and tenor assumptions; operationalized as an **eligibility calculator** productionized as an **Airflow DAG on Azure** for consistent, automated credit decisioning
- Build **PD forecasting models** incorporating macroeconomic decision variables (CPI, GDP, PMI) for portfolio management; research on leverage patterns and multi-bank funding exposure presented as a monthly economic outlook in senior risk review forums
- **Model validation** — feature-level univariate/bivariate analysis, review of feature-creation code and feature definitions, monotonicity and PDP behaviour checks for alignment with stated risk hypotheses — with end-to-end model replication and documentation to **build challenger models** for continuous benchmarking

Research Associate | Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bangalore Jan 2024 – Jun 2024

- Built a **QA engine for the electricity sector** using TAPAS + RAG for tabular data queries; designed a novel chunking method to overcome the 512-token limit; integrated Qdrant with a Cohere reranker to improve retrieval accuracy; deployed an interactive Streamlit dashboard

Data Scientist Intern | Bosch Pvt. Ltd. Jun 2023 – Jul 2023

- Built an **EV range-prediction digital twin** on BMW i3 real-world driving data (LSTM/Random Forest); deployed on AWS EC2 demonstrating scalability and production readiness

PROJECTS

- **BetaBot — Automated NSE Swing/Breakout Scanner** ([GitHub](https://github.com/saketkr06)) — daily scans of the Nifty 500 universe on GitHub Actions with parallelized data ingestion, ML-based signal ranking (TimeSeriesSplit validation), and broker-API integration for unattended operation; portfolio: saketkr06.github.io

EDUCATION

M.Mgmt (Business Analytics), Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bangalore — 8.5/10, Distinction 2024

B.Tech, University of Agricultural Sciences, Bangalore — 8.47/10 2022

12th (CBSE), Indian Public School, Purnia — 84.6% 2018

10th (CBSE), Millia Convent English School, Purnia — 10/10 CGPA 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Credit Risk: PD/LGD/EAD, Scorecard Development, WoE/IV, PSI/KS/Gini, Champion–Challenger, Model Validation & Governance, Roll-Rate Analysis, Portfolio Analytics

ML / AI: XGBoost, LightGBM, SHAP, Time Series Forecasting, Deep Learning (LSTM), LLMs & RAG (TAPAS, Qdrant, Cohere Reranker), LangGraph, QLoRA

Stack: Python, SQL, SAS, R, Apache Airflow, Azure, AWS, Power BI, Streamlit, Git/GitHub Actions

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **AIR-6, GATE 2022** (All India Rank 6)
- **Top Gun Award & Best Performer (Oct–Dec 2024)** — Kotak Mahindra Bank
- **National Talent Scholarship, ICAR (2018–2022)**